

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 6, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 36:16–31

16 Moreover the word of the Lord came to me, saying:

17 "Son of man, when the house of Israel dwelt in their own land, they defiled it by their own ways and deeds; to Me their way was like the uncleanness of a woman in her customary impurity.

18 Therefore I poured out My fury on them for the blood they had shed on the land, and for their idols with which they had defiled it.

19 So I scattered them among the nations, and they were dispersed throughout the countries; I judged them according to their ways and their deeds.

20 When they came to the nations, wherever they went, they profaned My holy name—when they said of them, 'These are the people of the Lord, and yet they have gone out of His land.'

21 But I had concern for My holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the nations wherever they went.

22 "Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord God: "I do not do this for your sake, O house of Israel, but for My holy name's sake, which you have profaned among the nations wherever you went.

23 And I will sanctify My great name, which has been profaned among the nations, which you have profaned in their midst; and the nations shall know that I am the Lord," says the Lord God, "when I am hallowed in you before their eyes.

24 For I will take you from among the nations, gather you out of all countries, and bring you into your own land.

25 Then I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you shall be clean; I will cleanse you from all your filthiness and from all your idols.

26 I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will take the heart of stone

out of your flesh and give you a heart of flesh.

27 I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, and you will keep My judgments and do them.

28 Then you shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers; you shall be My people, and I will be your God.

29 I will deliver you from all your uncleannesses. I will call for the grain and multiply it, and bring no famine upon you.

30 And I will multiply the fruit of your trees and the increase of your fields, so that you need never again bear the reproach of famine among the nations.

31 Then you will remember your evil ways and your deeds that were not good; and you will loathe yourselves in your own sight, for your iniquities and your abominations."

II. Key Summary

- God says that while Israel lived in their own land, they defiled it by their own ways and deeds, so He scattered them among the nations—and once they got there, they caused His name to be profaned by the people around them (vv. 16–21).
 - God says twice that what He is about to do is not for Israel's sake but for the sake of His own holy name; He will be shown holy in them so the nations will know He is the Lord (vv. 22–23).
 - God promises to gather them back from every country, sprinkle clean water on them to make them clean, give them a new heart and a new spirit, replace the heart of stone with a heart of flesh, put His Spirit within them, and make the land fruitful again (vv. 24–31).
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III. Passage Analysis

God's reason is in Himself, not in how good you've been

This excludes from man all dignity and means to deserve anything by, seeing that God refers the whole to himself and that only for the glory of his holy Name. [1]

When God says "I do not do this for your sake," He removes the whole idea that He treats you well because you performed well. His reason sits in who He is, not in how your week

has gone.

God changes your heart Himself—it's not something you pull off on your own

God will work an inward change in order to a universal change. Renewing grace works as great a change in the soul as the turning of a dead stone into living flesh. [2]

Turning a heart of stone into one that can feel is something no amount of effort on your part can pull off; only God can do it. And when He does it, He attaches no conditions—this new heart is grace, given freely.

IV. Reflection Question

What thought or attitude inside you is something only God can change?

Israel defiled the land God gave them, got scattered among the nations, and caused His name to be profaned there (vv. 16–21); yet God says He will take the heart of stone out of them and give them a heart of flesh (v. 26). He does it Himself, and He gives it freely.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Geneva Study Bible (commentary on Ezekiel 36:22),
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/36-22.htm>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Complete Commentary (Ezekiel 36),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_036.cfm